

BMW (BMWG.DE): 2Q26 preview: China drags but resilient US/Europe holds the Auto margin in the 1-3% guide; share buyback accelerates

Following BMW's release of 2Q26 retail volume and public pre-close call on July 10, in which the company confirmed the revised guidance from June 16 ([link](#)) and expects 2Q EBIT margins to be in line with the full-year range (1-3%), we slightly revise our estimates to reflect stronger US/Europe (+8%/+10% vs. previous GSe +2%/+2%), softer China volume (-30% vs. previous GSe -24%) and the split of Auto profitability. We now expect the company to report 2Q Group EPS of €1.72 (vs. Visible Alpha consensus €2.24) and Auto EBIT at €782mn or 2.9% margin (vs. VA cons €780mn or 2.8%). For FY26, we forecast an Auto margin at 2.6%, comprising a lower China JV margin (1.3%, cut from 2.3%) and a higher ex-JV margin (2.8%, raised from 2.7%). BMW is scheduled to report 2Q results on July 30.

Christian Frenes
+44(20)7051-8641 |
christian.frenes@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Monika Mengting Liu, CFA
+44(20)7051-7601 | monika.liu@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Shivam Kotecha
+1(332)245-7822 |
shivam.kotecha@gs.com
Goldman Sachs India SPL

Robert Triulzi
+44(20)7552-2281 |
robert.triulzi@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

- **Retail confirms the China-led weakness, with resilient offsets.** 2Q retail volume came in at 591k units (-4.9% yoy), reflecting 2Q weakness in China and parts of Asia-Pacific, partly offset by growth in Europe and the US. Mini and the BMW iX3 posted solid 2Q deliveries, with the latter tracking toward 100k orders. Encouragingly, management continues to expect to meet 2026 CO2 targets without pooling, and is accelerating iX3 production capacity (a second shift pulled forward in Debrecen, with a third under consideration), further supported by the 7-Series and all-new X5 (Neue Klasse tech, five powertrains [link](#)).
- **2Q auto margin still free from restructuring burden, to hold within reset 1-3% corridor.** On revenues, management pointed to a familiar set of pressures. Retail volume fell around 4.9%, with wholesale volumes down at a broadly similar rate, and pricing remained under pressure across many markets. On top of the volume and pricing weakness, the stronger Euro added a further drag on the reported top line. Walking down to EBIT, management confirmed that the 2Q margin will sit within the new 1-3% full-year corridor and anticipates headwinds from negative volume/mix/pricing, negative raw materials and currency effects, and a heavier D&A burden. Importantly, the restructuring costs will not impact the 2Q but land entirely in the 2H26, with the associated cash flow impact only coming through from 2027. Working the other way, cost reduction and tariff relief provide some support, but management was clear that these only partly offset the headwinds.
- **2Q Auto FCF positive but lower sequentially on working capital drag, share buyback acceleration provides balance sheet confidence.** On cash, the picture follows naturally from the EBIT weakness. Auto free cash flow is squeezed by the

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lower earnings and by a working-capital drag from inventory build-up amid iX3 and i3 launches, though depreciation and investment provide some cushion. The net result should still be positive free cash flow, but likely below the 1Q level. For FY26, we expect BMW to generate €3.1bn Auto FCF, well above the guidance floor of €2.5bn (VA cons €3.0bn). On capital return, the headline is that the share buyback has been accelerated by around five months versus the original plan (3rd tranche of the 3rd program in the amount of 625mn started on July 1 to be completed by Nov 30 instead of April 2027), which is a reassuring signal of balance-sheet confidence despite the earnings reset in our view.

- **2H26 carries risk from potential further China dealer support and the absence of Mexico/US tariff relief, though not impacting FY guide.** Finally, on the various puts and takes: in China, a dealer support payment (in the low-triple-digit millions of Euros) is expected at the end of the 2Q, and while no further support is planned for the 2H, management is willing to consider it if needed without affecting full-year guidance. The IEEPA benefit, also in the low-triple-digit millions, will be booked in 2Q and roughly washes against the China dealer support. On trade, the anticipated reduction in the Mexico-to-US tariff from 27.5% did not materialise, but this does not materially change guidance, according to management.

Exhibit 1: BMW estimate changes, new vs. old

€ mn	2026E			2027E			2028E			2029E			2026-29E		
	New	Old	New vs. Old	New	Old	New vs. Old	New	Old	New vs. Old	New	Old	New vs. Old	New	Old	New vs. Old
Revenues															
Auto	110,419	111,878	-1.3%	110,603	112,041	-1.3%	113,420	114,898	-1.3%	115,795	117,311	-1.3%	450,237	456,128	-1.3%
Motorcycles	3,128	3,128	0.0%	3,175	3,175	0.0%	3,222	3,222	0.0%	3,271	3,271	0.0%	12,795	12,795	0.0%
Financial Services	39,814	39,814	0.0%	40,411	40,411	0.0%	41,017	41,017	0.0%	41,632	41,632	0.0%	162,874	162,874	0.0%
Reconciliation	-27,477	-27,738	0.9%	-27,625	-27,883	0.9%	-28,247	-28,512	0.9%	-28,792	-29,063	0.9%	-112,141	-113,197	0.9%
Total Revenue	125,883	127,081	-0.9%	126,563	127,744	-0.9%	129,412	130,626	-0.9%	131,906	133,150	-0.9%	513,765	518,601	-0.9%
EBIT															
Auto	2,870	2,936	-2.2%	4,493	4,547	-1.2%	5,425	5,492	-1.2%	5,921	5,994	-1.2%	18,709	18,969	-1.4%
Motorcycles	183	183	0.0%	175	175	0.0%	187	187	0.0%	196	196	0.0%	741	741	0.0%
Financial Services	2,006	2,006	0.0%	2,425	2,425	0.0%	2,461	2,461	0.0%	2,498	2,498	0.0%	9,390	9,390	0.0%
Reconciliation	381	384	-0.9%	567	572	-0.8%	646	651	-0.8%	689	695	-0.8%	2,283	2,302	-0.8%
Total EBIT	5,440	5,509	-1.3%	7,659	7,718	-0.8%	8,719	8,791	-0.8%	9,304	9,384	-0.8%	31,123	31,402	-0.9%
EBIT Margin, %															
Auto	2.6%	2.6%	0.0pp	4.1%	4.1%	0.0pp	4.8%	4.8%	0.0pp	5.1%	5.1%	0.0pp	4.2%	4.2%	0.0pp
Motorcycles	5.8%	5.8%	0.0pp	5.5%	5.5%	0.0pp	5.8%	5.8%	0.0pp	6.0%	6.0%	0.0pp	5.8%	5.8%	0.0pp
Financial Services	5.0%	5.0%	0.0pp	6.0%	6.0%	0.0pp	6.0%	6.0%	0.0pp	6.0%	6.0%	0.0pp	5.8%	5.8%	0.0pp
Group EBIT Margin	4.3%	4.3%	0.0pp	6.1%	6.0%	0.0pp	6.7%	6.7%	0.0pp	7.1%	7.0%	0.0pp	6.1%	6.1%	0.0pp
Investments and Cash Flow															
R&D expenditure	6,973	7,039	-0.9%	5,316	5,365	-0.9%	5,824	5,878	-0.9%	6,595	6,658	-0.9%	24,708	24,940	-0.9%
Capital expenditure (PPE)	5,887	5,947	-1.0%	6,075	6,132	-0.9%	6,018	6,074	-0.9%	6,134	6,191	-0.9%	24,113	24,344	-0.9%
R&D Capitalization	2,273	2,295	-0.9%	1,860	1,878	-0.9%	2,038	2,057	-0.9%	2,374	2,397	-0.9%	8,546	8,627	-0.9%
Capitalization Ratio	32.6%	32.6%	0.0%	35.0%	35.0%	0.0%	35.0%	35.0%	0.0%	36.0%	36.0%	0.0%	34.6%	34.6%	0.0%
Free Cash Flow Auto	3,102	3,139	-1.2%	4,418	5,041	-12.4%	5,529	5,542	-0.2%	5,336	5,627	-5.2%	18,385	19,350	-5.0%
P&L															
Reported PBT	5,897	5,969	-1.2%	7,769	7,827	-0.7%	8,895	8,971	-0.8%	9,553	9,636	-0.9%	32,114	32,403	-0.9%
Tax	1,634	1,654	-1.2%	2,047	2,062	-0.7%	2,446	2,467	-0.8%	2,723	2,746	-0.8%	8,850	8,929	-0.9%
Reported net income	4,175	4,226	-1.2%	5,714	5,715	0.0%	6,608	6,617	-0.1%	7,168	7,178	-0.1%	23,665	23,737	-0.3%
EPS	7.01	7.13	-1.7%	10.10	10.17	-0.7%	12.22	12.32	-0.8%	13.99	14.20	-1.5%	43.32	43.81	-1.1%
Dividend	2.90	2.90	0.0%	3.60	3.60	0.0%	4.30	4.40	-2.3%	4.90	5.00	-2.0%	15.70	15.90	-1.3%
Group deliveries, wholesale	2,371,812	2,354,690	0.7%	2,363,320	2,345,421	0.8%	2,409,876	2,391,661	0.8%	2,446,944	2,428,600	0.8%	9,591,952	9,520,373	0.8%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: GSe vs. Visible Alpha Consensus Data

€ mn	2026E			2027E			2028E			2029E			2026-29E		
	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons
Revenues															
Auto	27,128	28,185	-3.7%	110,419	113,601	-2.8%	110,603	116,784	-5.3%	113,420	119,288	-4.9%	115,795	121,114	-4.4%
Motorcycles	966	954	1.3%	3,128	3,152	-0.8%	3,175	3,216	-1.3%	3,222	3,281	-1.8%	3,271	3,365	-2.8%
Financial Services	10,078	9,941	1.4%	39,814	39,697	0.3%	40,411	40,757	-0.8%	41,017	41,694	-1.6%	41,632	42,547	-2.2%
Reconciliation	-6,839	-6,428	-6.4%	-27,477	-26,296	-4.5%	-27,625	-26,897	-3.5%	-28,247	-27,239	-3.7%	-28,792	-27,459	-4.9%
Total Revenue	31,333	32,562	-3.8%	125,883	130,077	-3.2%	126,563	134,385	-5.8%	128,412	137,672	-6.0%	131,966	138,680	-5.6%
EBIT															
Auto	782	780	0.3%	2,870	3,122	-8.1%	4,493	5,043	-10.9%	5,425	6,207	-12.6%	5,921	6,920	-14.4%
Motorcycles	39	113	-65.7%	183	174	5.3%	175	182	-4.3%	187	199	-6.3%	196	219	-10.3%
Financial Services	561	608	-7.7%	2,006	2,187	-8.3%	2,425	2,370	2.3%	2,461	2,561	-3.9%	2,498	2,806	-11.0%
Reconciliation	69	265	-73.9%	381	886	-57.1%	567	714	-20.5%	646	565	14.2%	689	669	2.9%
Total EBIT	1,451	1,733	-16.3%	5,440	6,276	-13.3%	7,659	8,323	-8.0%	8,719	9,906	-12.0%	9,304	10,739	-13.4%
EBIT Margin, %															
Auto	2.9%	2.8%	0.1%	2.6%	2.7%	-0.1pp	4.1%	4.3%	-0.3pp	4.8%	5.2%	-0.4pp	5.1%	5.7%	-0.6pp
Motorcycles	4.0%	11.8%	-7.8%	5.8%	5.5%	0.3pp	5.5%	5.7%	-0.2pp	5.8%	6.1%	-0.3pp	6.0%	6.5%	-0.5pp
Financial Services	5.6%	6.1%	-0.6%	5.0%	5.5%	-0.5pp	6.0%	5.8%	0.2pp	6.0%	6.1%	-0.1pp	6.0%	6.6%	-0.6pp
Group EBIT Margin	4.6%	5.3%	-0.7%	4.3%	4.8%	-0.5pp	6.1%	6.2%	-0.1pp	6.7%	7.2%	-0.5pp	7.1%	7.7%	-0.6pp
Free Cash Flow Auto	178	890	-80.1%	3,102	2,822	9.9%	4,418	3,649	21.1%	5,529	4,749	16.4%	5,336	5,852	-8.8%
P&L															
Reported PBT	1,481	1,869	-20.8%	5,897	6,311	-6.6%	7,769	8,302	-6.4%	8,895	9,873	-9.9%	9,553	10,783	-11.4%
Tax	400	507	-21.2%	1,634	1,808	-9.6%	2,047	2,394	-14.5%	2,446	2,849	-14.1%	2,723	3,123	-12.8%
Reported net income	1,028	1,226	-16.2%	4,175	4,275	-2.3%	5,714	5,875	0.7%	6,609	6,809	-2.9%	7,168	7,435	-3.6%
EPS	1.72	2.24	-23.2%	7.01	6.98	0.4%	10.10	9.18	10.0%	12.22	11.36	7.6%	13.99	12.75	9.7%
Dividend				2.90	2.74	5.9%	3.60	3.54	1.6%	4.30	4.24	1.4%	4.90	4.60	6.6%
Group deliveries, wholesale	565,780	595,904	-5.1%	2,371,812	2,418,659	-1.9%	2,363,320	2,447,861	-3.5%	2,409,876	2,483,706	-3.0%	2,446,944	2,498,941	-2.1%

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

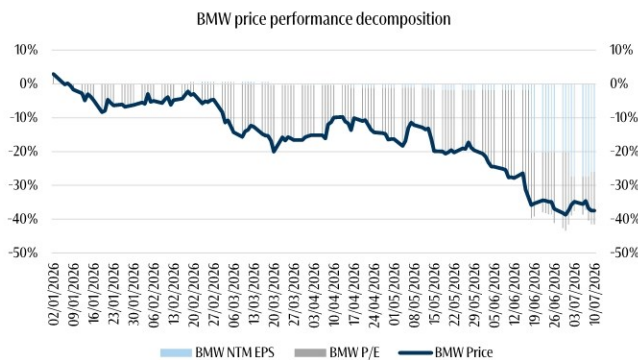
Valuation and key risks

Valuation - We value BMW on a P/E basis applying a target multiple of 7.5x on a 50/50 blend of FY27/28E EPS to reach a 12-month price target of €84 (unchanged). We are Buy rated.

Key downside risks include further slowdown in China premium market and pricing pressure, potential Neue Klasse ramp and software execution issues, slower-than-expected BEV profitability parity, investment intensity and capital allocation creep, potential tariffs and trade policy headwinds.

Exhibit 3: BMW's YTD price performance is primarily explained by multiple contraction and, following the June 19 profit warning, EPS downgrades.

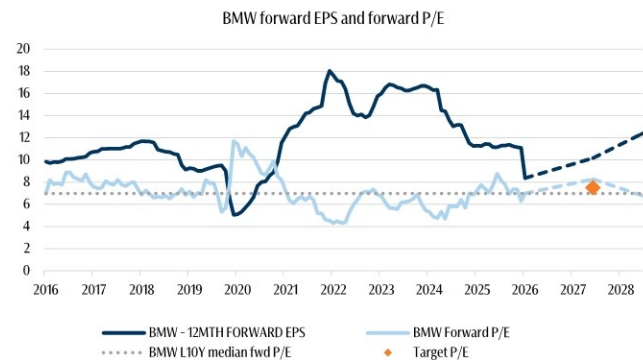
BMW 26YTD price performance decomposition



Source: LSEG, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

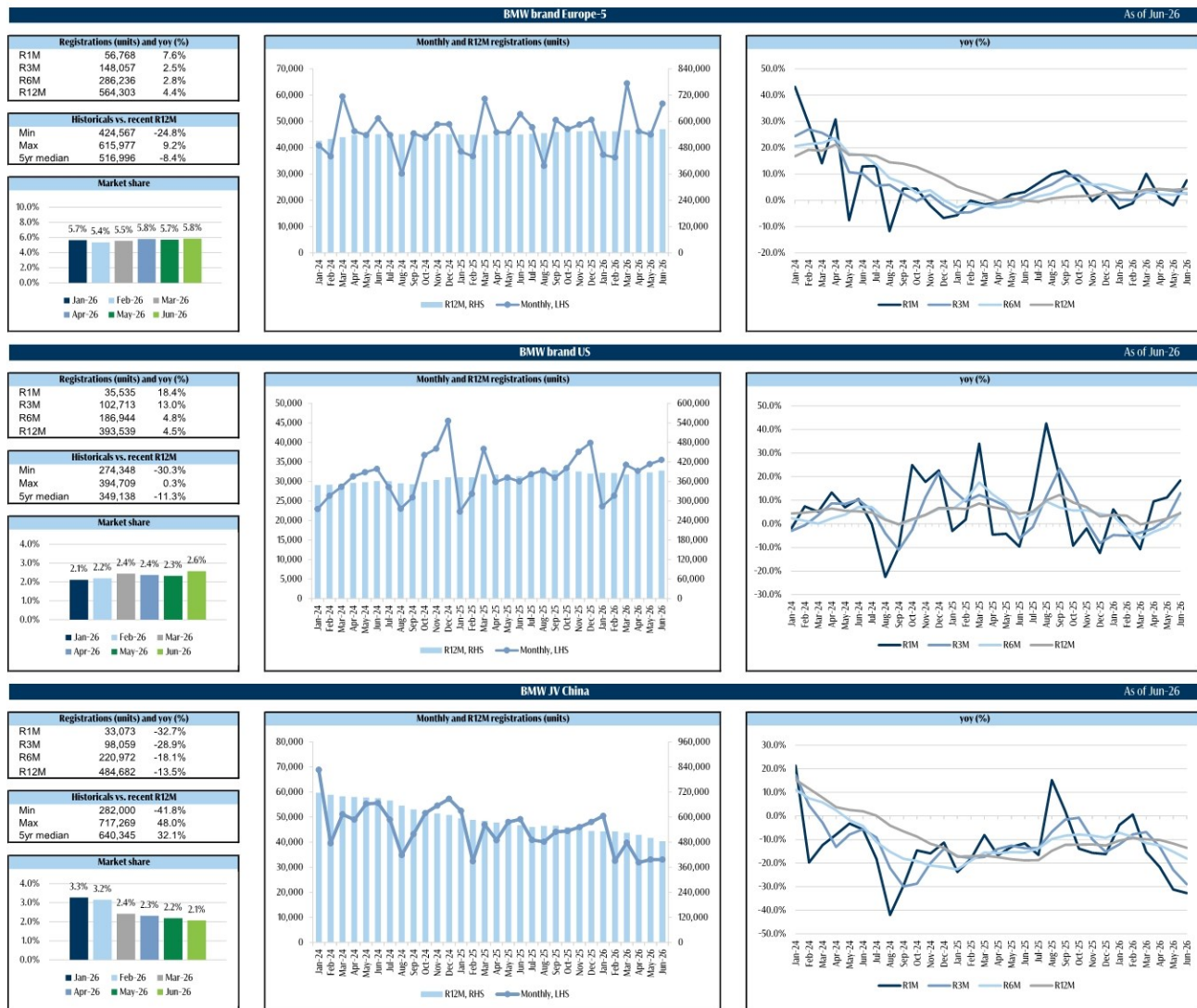
Exhibit 4: BMW is currently trading close to its 10-year historical median.

BMW 12m forward EPS (€) and P/E (x)



Source: LSEG, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Appendix

Exhibit 5: BMW US retail volume dashboard
 As of Jun-26


Source: SMMT, KBA, ANFAC, UNRAE, PFA, Autodata, CPCA, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

BMWG.DE	12m Price Target: €84.00	Price: €58.14	Upside: 44.5%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: €32.3bn / \$36.9bn Enterprise value: €(10.0)bn / \$(11.4)bn 3m ADTV: €103.1mn / \$119.5mn Germany Europe Autos M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (€ mn) New	133,453.0	125,883.2	126,563.3	129,412.4
	Revenue (€ mn) Old	133,453.0	127,080.7	127,743.9	130,625.7
	EBIT (€ mn)	10,186.0	5,439.8	7,659.2	8,719.3
	EPS (€) New	11.89	7.01	10.10	12.22
	EPS (€) Old	11.89	7.13	10.17	12.32
	P/E (X)	6.9	8.3	5.8	4.8
	Dividend yield (%)	5.4	5.0	6.2	7.4
	CROCI (%)	17.4	13.6	16.0	16.6
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(2.4)	(3.0)	(2.7)	(2.7)
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (€)	2.68	1.72	0.69	1.92

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Christian Frenes, Monika Mengting Liu, CFA, Shivam Kotecha and Robert Triulzi, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Contributing Authors: Christian Frenes Goldman Sachs International, Monika Mengting Liu, CFA Goldman Sachs International, Shivam Kotecha Goldman Sachs India SPL, Robert Triulzi Goldman Sachs International.

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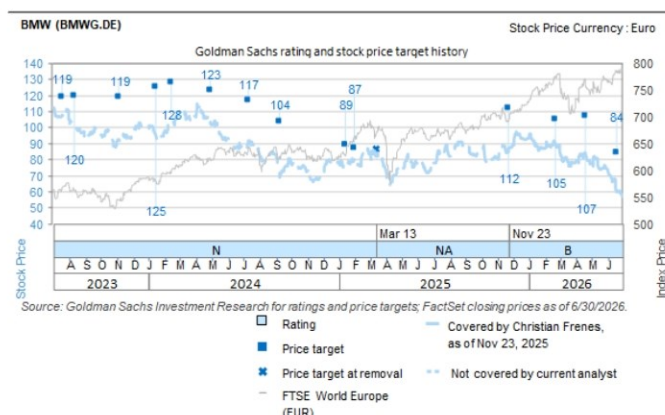
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Target price history table(s)

BMW (BMWG.DE)

Date of report Target price (€) Closing price (€)

18-Jun-26	84.00	59.74
21-Apr-26	107.00	83.48
22-Feb-26	105.00	90.32
23-Nov-25	112.00	85.08
30-Jan-25	87.00	79.88
14-Jan-25	89.00	75.98
10-Sep-24	104.00	68.98
12-Jul-24	117.00	92.18
29-Apr-24	123.00	106.80
14-Feb-24	128.00	101.16
16-Jan-24	125.00	95.76
07-Nov-23	119.00	91.31
11-Aug-23	120.00	99.99
19-Jul-23	119.00	107.20

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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